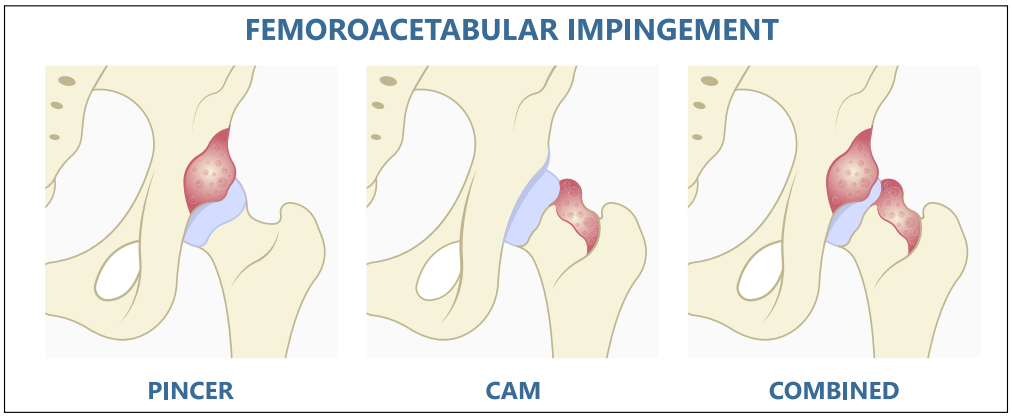
HIP: LABRAL TEAR, FEMOROACETABULAR IMPINGEMENT (FAI)

Background

- Femoroacetabular impingement (FAI) is a common cause of hip pain in young adults. It's caused by bony overgrowths in different areas of the hip joint. There are two types:
  - » **CAM-type:** Overgrowth on the head and neck of the femur.
  - » **Pincer-type:** Overgrowth on the hip socket (acetabulum).
- FAI is often associated with "hip labral tears." These are tears to the cartilage that lines your hip socket.
- Both FAI and labral tears often lead to deep hip pain during activity and movement. Symptoms often include stiffness, clicking, or a locking sensation in the hip joint.
- Diagnosis is made through a physical exam and, in some cases, imaging such as x-ray, MRI, or CT scan.
- Treatment includes rest, avoiding painful activities, physical therapy, medication, and injections. In some cases, surgery such as hip arthroscopy, osteoplasty, and labral repair is required.



Rehab Instructions





Posterior Trunk and Hip Stabilizers

Alternating Arms and Legs (left photos)

Alternating Arms only and Legs only (right photos)

1. Start on your hands and knees in a 4-point kneeling position.
2. Raise one arm and the opposite leg and keep your back in a neutral position. Hold for 10 seconds.
3. Slowly lower your arm and leg and repeat with your other arm and leg. Hold for another 10 seconds.
4. If you can't hold this position, you can modify this exercise by raising one limb at a time until all 4 limbs have been raised. One rotation of raising and holding all 4 limbs equals 1 rep.

Complete 3 sets of 10 reps 1 x a day.





Side-lying Leg lifts





1. Lie on one side with your legs straight.
2. Stabilize your body against a wall and place your arms on the floor to keep your upper body and hips from rotating by.
3. Leading with your heel, slowly lift your top leg, hold for 5 seconds, then slowly lower it back to the start position.
4. You should feel this in the outside muscles of your thigh. If not, adjust your position.

Complete 3 sets of 10 reps on each side 1 x a day.

Bridges





1. Lie on your back with your knees bent and feet flat on the floor, keeping your hips shoulder-width apart.
2. Contract your glute muscles and lift your hips towards the ceiling.
3. Keep your back flat; do not overextend (arch) your back.
4. Hold for 15–20 seconds, then slowly return to the start position.

Complete 3 sets of 10 reps 1 x a day.

Single Knee to Chest Stretch



1. Lie on your back with your legs straight and your feet resting on the floor.
2. Pull one knee to your chest and hold for 10–15 seconds.
3. While keeping that same knee bent, pull it towards the opposite shoulder and hold for another 10–15 seconds.
4. You should feel this stretch in your lower back, glutes, and upper hamstring muscles.
5. Repeat the stretch on the other side.

Complete 3 sets for 20–30 seconds total on each side 1 x a day.

Practical Tips For Success

- Complete these exercises in a slow, controlled manner. Be consistent and perform them 6 days a week.
- A running gait analysis may be helpful for you to optimize your biomechanics and prevent injury.
- Excess body weight loads the gluteal tendons. Maintaining a healthy body weight may be helpful in reducing symptoms.

References

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